Role of TamilNadu In Freedom Struggle

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Introduction:

❖ Freedom struggle in TAMILNADU was unique. also struggle for independence from social disability.

❖ The great leaders like G.subramanyalyer, V.O.Chidambaram Pillai, Subramanya Bharathi, Rajagopalachari,kamrajar,Thirupurkumaran and many others.

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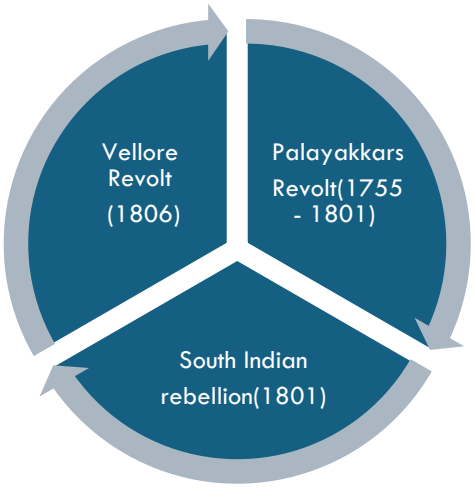
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Early agitation against British rule



Palayakkars

- palayakkars in Tamil refers to the holders of little kingdom as feudatory to a greater sovereign.
- "palayam" means military camp or a little
- kingdom Vijayanagara rulers appointed Nayaks and
- Nayaks of madurai appointed palayakkars.
- vishwanath Nayak under the guidance of minister Ariyanathar converted little kingdom into 72palayam.
- prathaba rudra of warrangal in the KAKATIYA kingdom. (1530s)

Division of Palayams

◉ **Eastern Palayams:**

- Sattur, Nagalapuram, Ettayapuram, Panchalakurichi, Kolathur
- Controlled by **Kattabomman**

◉ **Western Palayams:**

- Nerkattumseval, Uthumalai, Thalavankottai, Naduvakurichi, Singampatti, Sethur
- **Controlled by Pulithevan**

💰 East India Company Involvement

◉ **Nawab of Arcot**:

- Borrowed from East India Company (Carnatic Wars)
- Handed **land revenue collection** to the Company

◉ **Yusuf Khan (Khan Sahi**b):

- Entrusted with revenue collection from Palayakkars

◉ **Mahfuz Khan:**

- Appointed as the British representative in those regions

Pulithevan

⚔️ Puli Thevar's Revolt (1755–1767)

📍 Initial Conflict

- **1755**: Mahfuzkhan & Colonel Heron sent to suppress Puli Thevar.
- Puli Thevar resisted British & Nawab authority.
- Heron failed and was dismissed.

🤝 Formation of Confederacy

- Puli Thevar united western palayakkars (except Sivagiri).
- Sought support from:
    - Pathan officers of Madurai
    - French (not successful)
    - Hyder Ali (busy with Marathas)

⚔️ Battle of Kalakadu

- Puli Thevar allied with **Travancore** (2000 soldiers).
- Mahfuzkhan's army defeated.

🧨 British Intervention

- **Yusuf Khan** (Marudhanayagam) sent by Company to suppress revolt.
- **1760–1761**: Used artillery to capture Puli Thevar's forts:
    - Nerkattumseval
    - Vasudevanallur
    - Panayur

🪦 Fall of Confederacy

- After the French exit (Pondicherry captured), support for Puli Thevar weakened.
- Some palayams switched loyalty.
- Yusuf Khan negotiated secretly → executed in **1764** for treason.

💔 End of Rebellion

- Puli Thevar returned from exile in 1764.
- Recaptured Nerkattumseval.
- Defeated again in 1767 by Captain Campbell.
- Died in exile

Velunachiyar (1730–1796)

👑 Early Life

- Born in **1730** to **Raja Sellamuthu Sethupathy** of **Ramanathapuram**.
- Trained in **martial arts**, **weaponry**, **horse riding**, **archery**, and languages (English, French, Urdu).

💍 Marriage and British Attack

- Married to **Muthu Vadugar**, Raja of **Sivagangai**.
- Had a daughter: **Vellachinachiar**.
- **1772**: **Kalaiyar Kovil** Palace attacked by Nawab of Arcot & British under **Lt. Col. Bon Jour**.
- Muthu Vadugar killed; Velunachiyar escaped and stayed under **Gopala Nayak**'s protection in **Virupachi** for 8 years.

⚔️ Resistance Against the British

🛡️ Alliance Building

- Allied with **Hyder Ali**, Gopala Nayak.
- Military chief **Thandavarayanar** wrote to Hyder Ali for help.
- **Hyder Ali** provided military aid via his Dindigul commandant **Syed**.

🧠 Intelligence and Strategy

- Used spies to find British ammunition depots.
- Formed **Dindigul League** with:
    - **Gopala Nayak** (Virupachi)
    - **Lakshmi Nayak** (Manaparai)
    - **Poojai Nayak** (Devadanapatti)

🔥 Heroic Act of Kuyili (1780)

- Kuyili: Loyal commander of Velunachiyar's women army.
- Self-immolated in British arsenal to destroy ammunition.

👑 Restoration and Rule

- With support from **Hyder Ali** and **Marudhu Pandiyar**, she:
  - Recaptured **Sivagangai**.
  - Became the **first Indian queen to resist British colonial rule**.
  - Crowned ruler of Sivagangai.

⚔️ Gopala Nayak's Continued Resistance

- Led battles inspired by **Tipu Sultan**.
- Fought in **Aanamalai hills** with peasant support.
- Joined **Oomaidurai** (Kattabomman's brother).
- Defeated by British in **1801**

Veerapandya Kattabomman (1790–1799)

Early Leadership	• Became **Palayakkarar of Panchalamkurichi** at age **30** after his father's death. • Initially considered **peaceful** by Company officers James London & Colin Jackson.
Tax Dispute with East India Company	• Under 1781 treaty, **Company collected revenue** from Carnatic. • Kattabomman's **tax arrears in 1798** were **3310 pagodas**. • **Collector Jackson** tried to force collection, worsening relations.
Confrontation with Jackson (1798) •	• Kattabomman summoned to **Ramanathapuram**. • **September 19, 1798**: After being insulted and made to stand for 3 hours, Kattabomman **escaped with Oomaithurai's help**.

	• Clash occurred at fort gate; **Lt. Clarke killed**, and **Sivasubramanianar captured**
Madras Council Inquiry	• **Kattabomman cleared of charges** in inquiry on **15 December 1798**. • **Jackson dismissed**, **Sivasubramanianar released**. • Kattabomman paid most dues, leaving only **1080 pagodas**.
Confederacy of Palayakkarars	• Formed by **Marudhu Pandiyar** (Sivagangai). • Members included **Gopala Nayak (Dindigul)**, **Yadul Nayak (Aanamalai)**. • Kattabomman supported the **Tiruchirappalli Proclamation**. • **British blocked his meeting** with Marudhu Pandiyars.
Conflict with Sivagiri & Company Response	• Kattabomman advanced towards **Sivagiri**, a **tributary of the Company**. • This was seen as a **challenge**, prompting British military response.
Siege of Panchalamkurichi (Sept 1799)	• Lord **Wellesley** ordered an attack. • Major **Bannerman** led British and **Travancore troops**. • **1 Sept**: Kattabomman given ultimatum; he refused to surrender. • **5 Sept**: Fort surrounded and communications cut. • **Ramalinganar** betrayed fort secrets; **Sivasubramanianar captured** at **Kolarpatti**.
Fall and Execution	• Kattabomman **escaped to Pudukottai**. • **Betrayed** by Rajas of **Ettayapuram** and **Pudukottai**. • **Sivasubramanianar executed** on **13 Sept 1799** at Nagalapuram. • **Kattabomman captured**, mock trial held on **16 Oct 1799**. • **Hanged at Kayathar** (near Tirunelveli) from a tamarind tree.

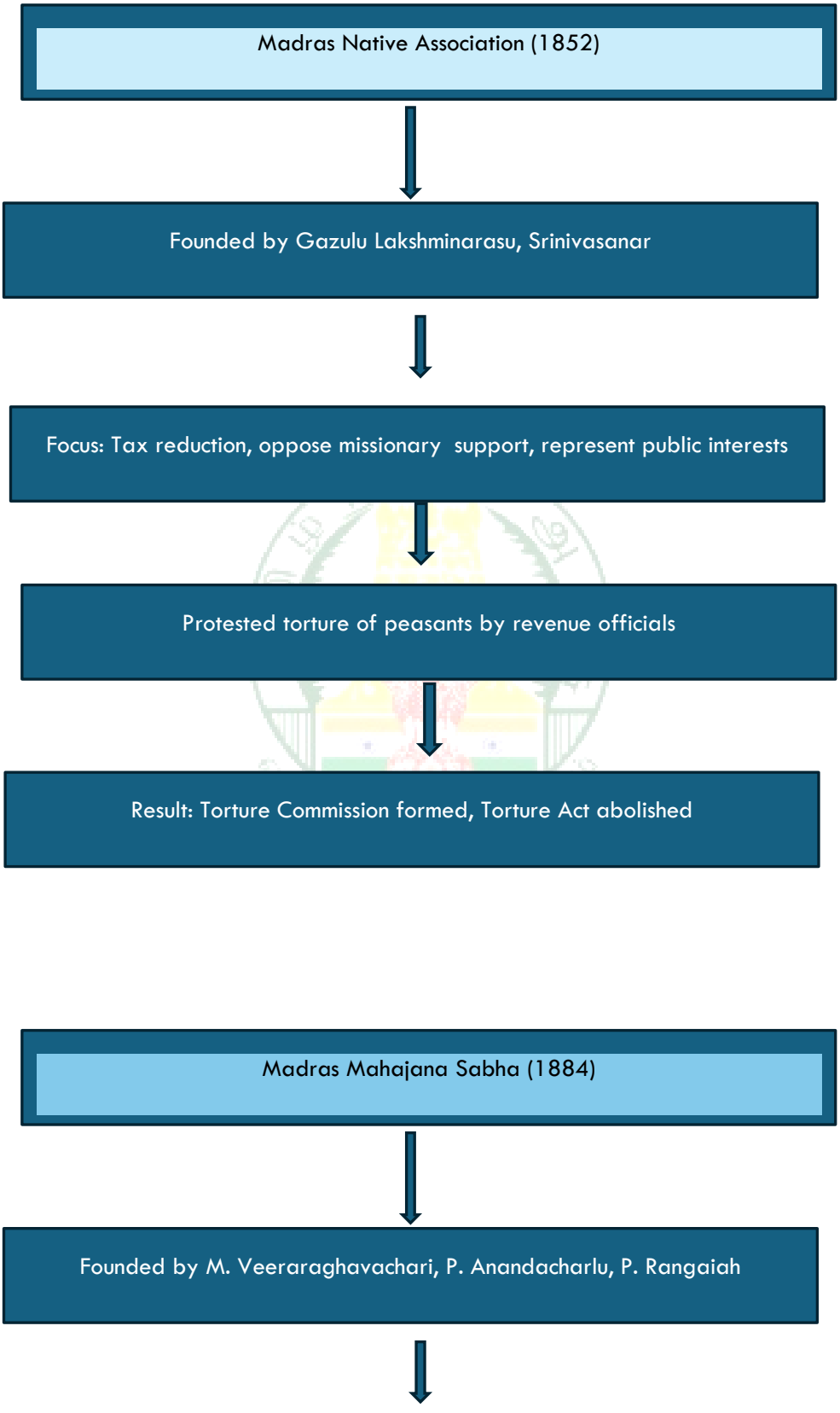
The Marudhu Brothers' Rebellion (1800–1801)

- **Periya (Vella) Marudhu (1748–1801)** and **Chinna Marudhu (1753–1801)** were generals under **Muthu Vadugar** of Sivagangai.
- After Muthu Vadugar's death at **Kalaiyar Kovil**, they helped **Velunachiyar** reclaim her throne.
- Became key leaders of **resistance against the British** in South Tamil Nadu.

Second Palayakkarar War / Rebellion (1800–1801)	• After Kattabomman's execution (1799), a **second uprising** erupted. • Led by a **confederacy**: • **Marudhu Pandyan (Sivagangai)** • **Gopala Nayak (Dindigul)** • **Kerala Varma (Malabar)** • **Krishnappa Nayak & Dhoondaji (Mysore)** • **April 1800**: Rebels met at **Virupachi** and planned the revolt. • **June 1800**: Uprising began in **Coimbatore**, spreading to **Ramanathapuram** and **Madurai**.
British Response	• Declared war on rebel leaders. • Captured and hanged Palayakkarars from Coimbatore, Sathyamangalam, and Tarapuram.
Support from Kattabomman's Brothers •	• **Oomathurai and Sevathaiah** escaped from prison (Feb 1801). • Sheltered by **Chinna Marudhu** at **Siruvayal**. • **Panchalamkurichi fort rebuilt**, retaken by British in **April 1801**.

	• British demanded surrender of Kattabomman's brothers – Marudhu brothers **refused**.
Tiruchirappalli Proclamation (1801)	• **Issued by Marudhu Pandiyar in June 1801.** • **Call for unity across region, caste, creed, and religion against British rule.** • **Posted on Nawab's palace in Tiruchirappalli and Srirangam temple walls.** • **Marked as one of the first nationalistic calls against British rule in India.**
Fall of the Rebellion	• **May 1801**: British attacked rebels in Thanjavur and Tiruchirappalli. • Rebels moved to **Piranmalai** and **Kalayarkoil** but were defeated again. • **Divide and Rule policy** weakened the confederacy. • **Sivagangai annexed in 1801**.
Executions and Aftermath	• **24 Oct 1801**: **Marudhu Brothers executed** at **Tirupathur Fort** near Ramanathapuram. • **16 Nov 1801**: **Oomathurai and Sevathaiah beheaded** at **Panchalamkurichi**. • **73 rebels** exiled to **Penang (Malaya)**.
Carnatic Treaty (31 July 1801)	• Resulted in: • **End of Palayakkarar system**. • **British assumed direct control** over Tamilagam. • **Demolition of forts** and **disbandment of native armies**.

Role of TamilNadu in Freedom Struggle



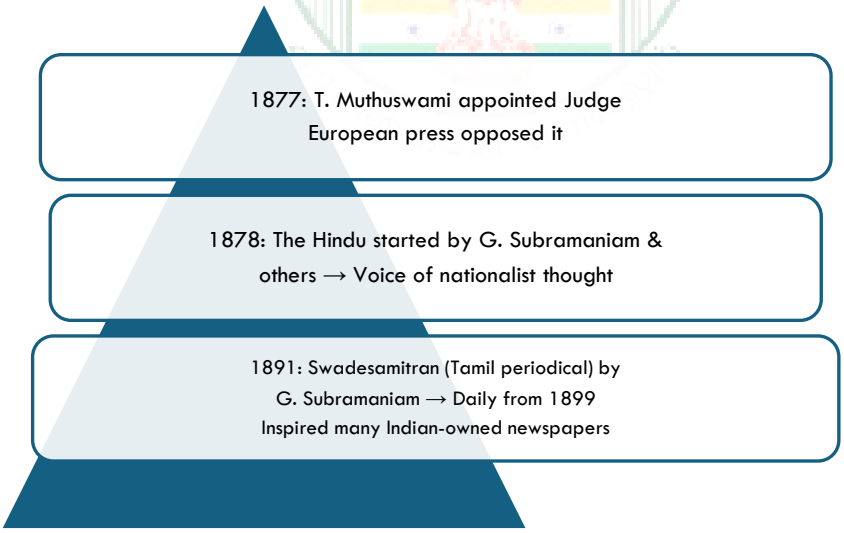
Aimed to communicate public demands to govt through meetings & petitions

Key Demands:

- Civil services exams in India & UK
- Abolition of Council of India in London
- Reduce taxes, military/civil expenses

Many of these ideas adopted by Congress (founded in 1885)

Nationalist Press



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Moderate Phase

Provincial Associations like Madras Mahajana Sabha

Led to formation of an all-India body **Indian National Congress (INC)**

December 1884: Key Meeting at Theosophical Society, Adyar (Madras)

Attended by National Leaders:
Dadabhai Naoroji, K.T. Telang,
Surendranath Banerjee
G. Subramaniam, Rangaiah, Anandacharlu

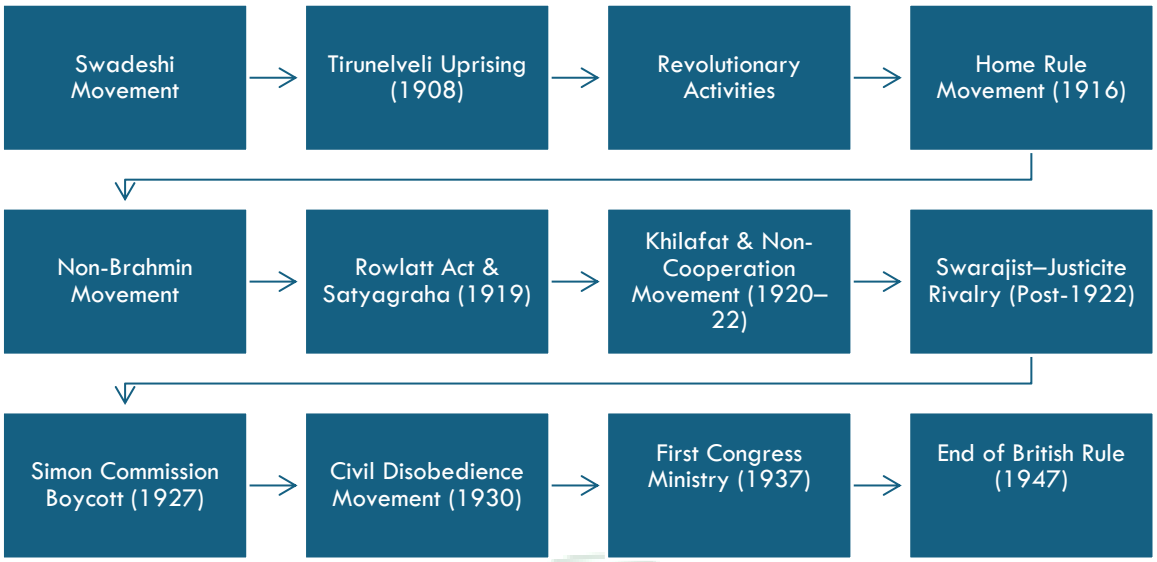
1885: First INC Session in Bombay 72 Delegates; 22 from Madras

1886: Second Session in Calcutta
President: Dadabhai Naoroji

1887: Third INC Session in Madras
Venue: Makkis Garden (Thousand Lights)
President: Badruddin Tyabji
607 Delegates; 362 from Madras Presidency

Tamil Nadu part of larger Madras Presidency Included parts of: Andhra, Karnataka, Kerala, and Odisha

Freedom Struggle in Tamil Nadu (1905–1947)



1. Partition of Bengal (1905) → Start of Swadeshi Movement

↓

2. Swadeshi Movement in Tamil Nadu

- ├── Leaders: V.O. Chidambaranar, Subramania Bharati, V. Chakkaraiyar, Surendranath Arya
- ├── Use of Tamil in public platforms
- ├── Swadeshi journals: **Swadesamitran, India**
- ├── Bipin Chandra Pal's visit inspired youths
- └── Launch of Swadeshi Steam Navigation Company by V.O.C

3. Tirunelveli Uprising (1908)

- ├── Strike in Coral Mills by V.O.C and Subramania Siva
- ├── Sedition charges, imprisonment, riots in Tirunelveli
- └── Subramania Bharati moved to Pondicherry

4. Revolutionary Activities

├— Pondicherry: Base for revolutionaries (M.P.T. Acharya, Aurobindo Ghosh, V.V. Subramanianar)

├— Radical journals: **India, Vijaya, Suryodayam**

└— Ashe Murder (1911) by Vanchinathan

5. Annie Besant & Home Rule Movement (1916)

├— Home Rule League founded

├— Aided by G.S. Arundale, B.P. Wadia, C.P. Ramaswami

├— **Newspapers: New India, Commonweal**

└— Promoted idea of Home Rule

6. Non-Brahmin Movement

├— Madras Dravidian Association (1912)

├— South Indian Liberal Federation (SILF) founded (1916)

└— Justice Party wins 1920 elections; A. Subbarayalu becomes CM

7. Rowlatt Act & Satyagraha (1919)

├— Rowlatt Act (arrests without trial)

├— Protest in Marina Beach by Rajaji, S. Satyamurti, V.O.C, Thiru. V. Ka

└— Formation of Madras Satyagraha Sabha

8. Khilafat & Non-Cooperation Movement (1920–22)

├— Khilafat agitation in Tamil Nadu (Vaniyambadi, Erode)

├— No-tax campaign in Thanjavur

├— Temperance movement (liquor ban)

├— Boycott of Prince of Wales' visit

└— Withdrawal after Chauri Chaura incident

9. Swarajist–Justicite Rivalry (Post-1922)

- ├── Swarajists (S. Satyamurti, S. Srinivasanar) wanted council entry
- ├── Rajaji (No-changer) M.A. Ansari , Kasturirangar opposed it
- └── Justice Party stayed in power till 1937

Withdrawal of Non-Cooperation Movement

Congress Split:

◉ No-Changers: Continued

◉ Pro-Changers: Wanted to enter councils

- Swaraj Party Founded (1923) by Chittaranjan Das & Motilal Nehru
- Swaraj Party in Tamil Nadu Led by S. Srinivasanar & S. Satyamurthy
- 1926 Elections: Swarajists won majority of elected seats did not accept office due to Congress policy

10. Simon Commission Boycott (1927)

- ├── All-white commission protested
- ├── S. Satyamurti led boycott in Madras
- └── Neill Statue agitation (symbol of colonial repression)

- protest came from all over Madras presidency led by S.N. Somayajalu of Tirunelveli.
- ⇢ The statue was finally moved to Madras Museum during Rajaji Govt in 1937.

11. Civil Disobedience Movement (1930)

├── **Vedaranyam Salt March** by Rajaji from **Tiruchirapalli on 13 April 1930 and reached Vedaranyam in Thanjavur district on 28 April.**

│ └── Song by Namakkal V. Ramalingam

├── Agitations in Tiruvallikeni, Rameswaram

├── Women participation: **Rukmani Lakshmipathi**

├── Arya hoisted flag at **Fort St. George** (1932)

└── **Martyr: Tirupur Kumaran**

12. First Congress Ministry (1937)

├── Rajaji as CM: introduced prohibition & sales tax

├── Resigned in protest of World war - II entry

└── Anti-Hindi Agitation (E.V. Ramasamy led)

- The Scheduled Castes Federation and the Muslim League extended its support to the anti-Hindi agitation.
- Natarajan and Thalamuthu, two of the enthusiastic agitators died in prison.

13. Quit India Movement (1942)

On 8 August 1942 the Quit India resolution was passed and Gandhi gave the slogan **'Do or Die'. The entire Congress**

leadership was arrested overnight.

├── Kamaraj went underground to organize movement

├── Strikes: Madras Port Trust, Corporation, Tramway

├── Students & women joined protests

└── Movement suppressed brutally

Mass Movement

⇢ The airport in Sulur was attacked and trains derailed in Coimbatore.

⇢ Congress Volunteers clashed with the military in Madurai. There was Police firing at Rajapalayam,Karaikudi and Devakottai.

⇢ The Royal Indian Navy Mutiny.

⇢ The newly elected Labour party govt in England resulting in India's independence

14. End of British Rule (1947)

├── Role of INA, Navy Mutiny & Labour Govt in Britain

└── **India’s Independence with Partition**